Why I want to join Welbi

A cosy game I built solo with AI, and what it taught me about building for people.

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Welbi makes software that helps older adults stay connected and engaged. That is the kind of work I want to do: warm, clear, kind to the person using it. I proved I can build that kind of product on my own with **Gnome Venture** (gnomeventure.ca), a free, no-monetization garden game with a village, a map, a kitchen and an almanac, live at version 2.4.89.

HOW I USED AI

- **As a team, not a vending machine.** Claude wrote and refactored the PHP (82 pages, about 74,000 lines) and its tests. I set direction, wrote the product rules and made every taste call.
- **A real art pipeline.** I wrote an art guide, then split the work by strength: a fast model writes the Aseprite Lua, a stronger model draws, in two passes where the second must change at least 8% of the pixels. Automated checks reject blur, stray pixels and off-style output.
- **Human gates.** I review every batch by eye, say what is wrong ("too fat", "noses are weak"), and approve spend before anything scales. Measured cost: about 58,000 tokens per finished item, which let me decide what to scale and what to stop.
- **Systems, not one-offs.** The gnome is a 10-layer recolourable rig; the welcome flow ships with a hand-off brief so another developer or AI can implement it.

6,680
image files in the game

36+
items redrawn so far, rollout under way

2 passes
per piece, the second must change a lot

NEW ART, BEFORE → AFTER











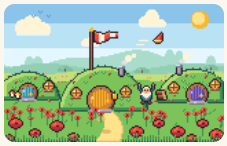






Same gnome, 12 recolours from one 10-layer rig.





Welcome-flow art: meadow stage and the Poppyburrow village card.

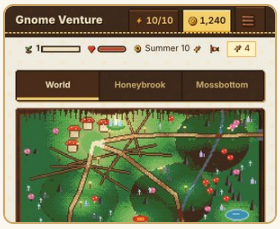
BUILT FOR COMFORT

Large tap targets (44 px minimum), no sideways scrolling, light and dark themes, reduced-motion support, colour never the only signal, one clear action per screen, and plain language. These are the habits I would bring to a product used by older adults.

THE GAME







Screens from the real game build: garden beds, a town market, and the Maplewold map. Mobile-first at 412 px.

Play it: **gnomeventure.ca**